

TRACK

Monitoring Progress Toward the Patient's Goals



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APPLYING FUNCTIONAL MEDICINE IN CLINICAL PRACTICE

Disclosures

Monique T. Class, MS, ARNP-BC disclosed no relevant financial relationships with ineligible companies.

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Learning Objectives

At the conclusion of this segment, successful participants will be able to:

1. Explain the role of various modalities, assets, and care team members in tracking patient progress.
2. Explain the importance of re-evaluating the patient's goals, preferences, context, and circumstances, and adjusting regimens and making referrals as indicated.

IFM Clinical Skills and Performance Objectives

This segment will enable participants to develop & apply these skills in their practice:

1. Utilize data from physical exam, monitorial clinical tools, evaluative testing, and the collaborative care team to accurately evaluate progress toward mitigating symptoms, correcting clinical imbalances, improving physiological dysfunction, and achieving patient goals.
2. Periodically re-evaluate the patient's goals, preferences, context, and circumstances. Adjust regimens and make referrals as indicated.

GOTOIT Functional Medicine Framework

G

GATHER oneself and clinical indicators on the IFM Functional Medicine Timeline.

O

ORGANIZE clinical indicators and imbalances on the IFM Functional Medicine Matrix.

T

TELL the patient's story to ensure a shared understanding.

O

ORDER and prioritize interventions feasible for the patient.

I

INITIATE referrals, evaluative tests, and therapeutic modalities.

T

TRACK and adjust evaluative and therapeutic regimens.

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Clinical Focus:

- Description and elements of the Track step of the GOTOIT method.



The Functional Medicine Clinical Method

GOTOIT:

The six steps of the functional medicine clinical method

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Long Description

- Go to it functional medicine framework
- G
- Gather oneself and clinical findings on the I F M functional medicine timeline
- O
- Organize clinical findings and imbalances on the I F M functional medicine matrix
- T
- Tell the patient's story to ensure a shared understanding
- O
- Order and prioritize interventions feasible for the patient
- I
- Initiate referrals, evaluative tests, and therapeutic modalities
- T
- Track and adjust evaluate and therapeutic regimens

Track

Track and monitor the effectiveness of and adherence to the initiated interventions as well as interval life events and changes in the patient's circumstances.

Adjust and refine previous interventions, and/or initiate new interventions as clinically indicated.

The “TRACK” Step of GOTOIT

TRACK further assessments, note the effectiveness of the therapeutic approach, and identify clinical outcomes at each visit—in partnership with the patient.



GOTOIT

The sequence of steps used in the practice of functional medicine:

GOTOIT Step and Definition	IFM Tools (examples)	Clinical Actions
G – GATHER oneself with a brief personal practice prior to prepare for each patient encounter. Take a detailed functional medicine history that includes the essential health events and features of a patient's life documented on the IFM Timeline in the process of organizing the patient's data.	• Cultivating Self Awareness and Mindfulness • Adult Intake Form • Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) • PROMIS Questionnaires • Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal • Functional Medicine Tree • Functional Medicine Timeline	• Use the Cultivating Self-Awareness and Mindfulness document to help gather yourself before every patient encounter. • The Adult Intake Form is used to gather initial intake information. Whereas, the MSQ, PROMIS Questionnaires, and Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal help gather initial symptom, function, and dietary information. • Map root causes (antecedents, triggers, mediators (ATMs)) and effects (clinical findings, current concerns) of physiological dysfunction on the Functional Medicine Timeline.
O – ORGANIZE the data gathered in the previous step and document them on the IFM Timeline and Matrix to identify the personalized root causes of current concerns, dysfunctions, and conditions, and to begin to prioritize the order (sequence) of interventions.	• Functional Medicine Tree • Functional Medicine Timeline • Functional Medicine Matrix • Adult Intake Form • Medical Symptom Questionnaire (MSQ) • PROMIS Questionnaires • Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal	• Using the Functional Medicine Matrix, populate ATMs, clinical findings, and current concerns from the Timeline. Add modifiable lifestyle factors (MLFs) and mental, emotional, spiritual factors (MES) to support the identification of the most important areas of physiological dysfunction.
T – TELL the life story back to the patient to ensure accuracy and a shared understanding. This dialogue, focused on the Timeline, highlights how factors elicited in the Gather step may have contributed to current or future clinical findings, concerns, health status and trajectory. The patient is asked to join in correcting the story, engendering a context of true partnership.	• Functional Medicine Matrix • Functional Medicine Timeline • Functional Medicine Tree	• The Functional Medicine Timeline is used to re-tell the patient's story while correlating prior events and root causes with current concerns or conditions. Ask the patient to join in for corrections or additional context. • Use the Functional Medicine Tree to explain how the root causes have contributed to the patient's condition.

Long Description

- Clinical Toolkit item: G O T O I T, Steps Practicing Functional Medicine, accessible version available in course materials. The second T in G O T O I T stands for Track. The functional medicine practitioner should track further assessments, note the effectiveness of the therapeutic approach, and identify clinical outcomes at each visit—in partnership with the patient. Additional I F M toolkit items helpful for tracking are the Medical Symptoms Questionnaire and Body Composition Tracking.

Clinical Focus:

- Modalities that facilitate effective monitoring and tracking of the patient's progress.



Track: Goals & Resources

1. Trajectory of symptoms and adherence
2. Toolkit assets
3. Anthropometrics
4. Wearables and devices
5. Laboratory/evaluative testing
6. Nutritionist/Pharmacist/Coach/Dentist
7. Other professionals as indicated
8. Changes in patient context/circumstances

TRACK Symptom Trajectory: Medical Symptoms Questionnaire & PROMIS Questionnaires

Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ)

Patient Name _____ Date _____

Instructions

Use this point scale to rate each of the following symptoms based on your typical health profile for the past 14 days:

0 = Never or almost never have the symptom	3 = Frequently have it; effect is not severe
1 = Occasionally have it; effect is not severe	4 = Frequently have it; effect is severe
2 = Occasionally have it; effect is severe	

Head

- Headaches
- Faintness
- Dizziness
- Insomnia
- Total

Eyes

- Watery or itchy eyes
- Swollen, reddened, or sticky eyelids
- Bags or dark circles under eyes
- Blurred or tunnel vision (doesn't include nearsightedness or farsightedness)
- Total

Ears

- Itchy ears
- Earaches, ear infections
- Drainage from ear
- Ringing in ears, hearing loss
- Total

Nose

- Stuffy nose
- Sinus problems
- Hay fever
- Sneezing attacks
- Excessive mucus formation
- Total

Please continue on the next page

Version 3



PROMIS Questionnaires

The Patient-Reported Outcomes Measurement Information System (PROMIS) is a collection of validated questionnaires used by healthcare practitioners and researchers to evaluate and monitor over 300 aspects of physical, mental, and social health in adults and children. PROMIS questionnaires examine many components of health including pain, digestion, mood, social support, cognition, life satisfaction, and much more.

About PROMIS for Healthcare Practitioners

- PROMIS questionnaires are available in English, Spanish, and many other languages.
- Questionnaires can be used to support communication between healthcare practitioners and patients.
- Questionnaires provide practitioners a reliable way to track symptoms and functions for the general population as well as those living with chronic conditions.

The PROMIS-Global Health (PROMIS-GH) Questionnaire

- A widely available, quick, 10-question validated research tool to collect patient reported outcomes.
- Focuses on function; specifically: physical, mental, and social well-being, and quality of life making it compatible with the functional medicine matrix model.
- Helps clinicians measure and adjust the patient-centered treatment response through self-reported outcomes; which supports the therapeutic partnership.
- Provides data to support functional medicine's inclusion in value-based care models.
- Provides a standardized measure that can be implemented in clinics, institutions, and research studies to collect data and help with the advancement of functional medicine.^{1,2}

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Long Description

- Clinical Toolkit items to support Track of G O T O I T include the Medical Symptoms Questionnaire or M S Q, and the P R O M I S Questionnaires. Accessible versions of these items are available in course materials.

Medical Symptoms Questionnaire

Medical Symptoms Questionnaire (MSQ)

Patient Name _____ Date _____

Instructions

Use this point scale to rate each of the following symptoms based on your typical health profile for the past 14 days:

0 = Never or almost never have the symptom	3 = Frequently have it; effect is not severe
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2 = Occasionally have it; effect is severe	

Head

- _____ Headaches
- _____ Faintness
- _____ Dizziness
- _____ Insomnia
- _____ Total

Eyes

- _____ Watery or itchy eyes
- _____ Swollen, reddened, or sticky eyelids
- _____ Bags or dark circles under eyes
- _____ Blurred or tunnel vision (doesn't include nearsightedness or farsightedness)
- _____ Total

Ears

- _____ Itchy ears
- _____ Earaches, ear infections
- _____ Drainage from ear
- _____ Ringing in ears, hearing loss
- _____ Total

Nose

- _____ Stuffy nose
- _____ Sinus problems
- _____ Hay fever
- _____ Sneezing attacks
- _____ Excessive mucus formation
- _____ Total

Please continue on the next page

Version 3

Accessible version of this resource in your toolkit.

Long Description

- Clinical Toolkit item: Medical Symptoms Questionnaire or M S Q, accessible version available in course materials.

PROMIS Questionnaires



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Long Description

- Clinical Toolkit item: P R O M I S Questionnaires, accessible version available in course materials.

TRACK Adherence to Regimen: Diet, Nutrition & Lifestyle Journal



Diet, Nutrition & Lifestyle Journal—7 Day

Patient Name _____
Date _____
Food Plan Type _____

Day 1

Day Event	Food & Drink Intake (include type, amount, brand)	Macronutrients (PFC) and Phytonutrients
Rising Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
Breakfast Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
Mid-AM Snack Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
Lunch Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
Mid-PM Snack Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
Dinner Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
PM Snack Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR
Bed Time		P _____ F _____ C _____ R ☐ O ☐ Y ☐ G ☐ B/P/BL ☐ W/T/BR

P: Protein; F: Fat; C: Carbohydrate; R: Red; O: Orange; Y: Yellow; G: Green; B/P/BL: Blue/Purple/Black; W/T/BR: White/Tan/Brown

Sleep & Relaxation	Exercise & Movement	Stress	Relationships
Sleep Quantity _____ (hrs) Quality: ☐ Poor ☐ Fair ☐ Good Relaxation ☐ Yes ☐ No Type/Amount: 	Type, Duration, & Intensity ☐ Aerobic: ☐ Strength: ☐ Flexibility: 	Stress reduction practices: Stressors: 	Supporting: Non-supporting:

Mental	Emotional	Spiritual

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Long Description

- Clinical Toolkit item: T R A C K Adherence to Regimen: Diet, Nutrition, and Lifestyle Journal, accessible version available in course materials.

Using Anthropometrics to TRACK

- Weight, BMI, BRI, WC, HC, BP (including orthostatic)
- Also emphasize these functional/dynamic evaluations:
 - Grip strength
 - Get up and go
 - Walking speed
 - One-foot stand

Using Wearables and Devices to TRACK

- Biometric wearable ring and other sleep monitors
- Movement trackers, step counters, and other exercise monitors
- Meal composition apps; phone photos of meals; others
- HRV and other stress monitors

Using Laboratory Testing to TRACK

- Conventional labs: functional interpretation of results
- Functional labs: judicious use
- Choosing wisely: will the result change your decisions?
- Comparison of before/after interventions
- Dual purpose results for patient motivation and adherence
- Avoiding interpretation of results as “permanent labels”

Getting Healthy Is a Team Sport



TRACK: Referrals to Nutrition Professionals

- Compare before/after ABCDs of functional nutrition
- Deploy IFM TKIs (informational/evaluative/therapeutic)
- Interpret wearable/device data
- Adjust dietary recommendations
- Use of nutrition apps

TRACK: Referrals to Pharmacists

- Medication/supplement therapy management
- Drug-supplement and supplement-supplement interactions
- Drug-induced nutrient deficiencies
- De-escalate and/or de-prescribe medications and supplements as patient function improves

TRACK: Referrals to Dentists

- Oral/dental health for mastication/digestion
- Oral dysbiosis
- Any patient with chronic inflammation: oral cavity as nidus
- Oral/dental sources of toxicity

TRACK: Referrals to Coaches

- Accountability
- Refine/reinforce behavior change and motivation
- Refine/advance SMART goals
- Adherence to diet and lifestyle interventions
- Group visits/shared medical appointments
- Remote patient monitoring
- **Revisiting the patient's goals, priorities, preferences, context, and circumstances; adjust regimens accordingly**

TRACK: The Patient's Circumstances

How have the patient's goals and objectives changed?



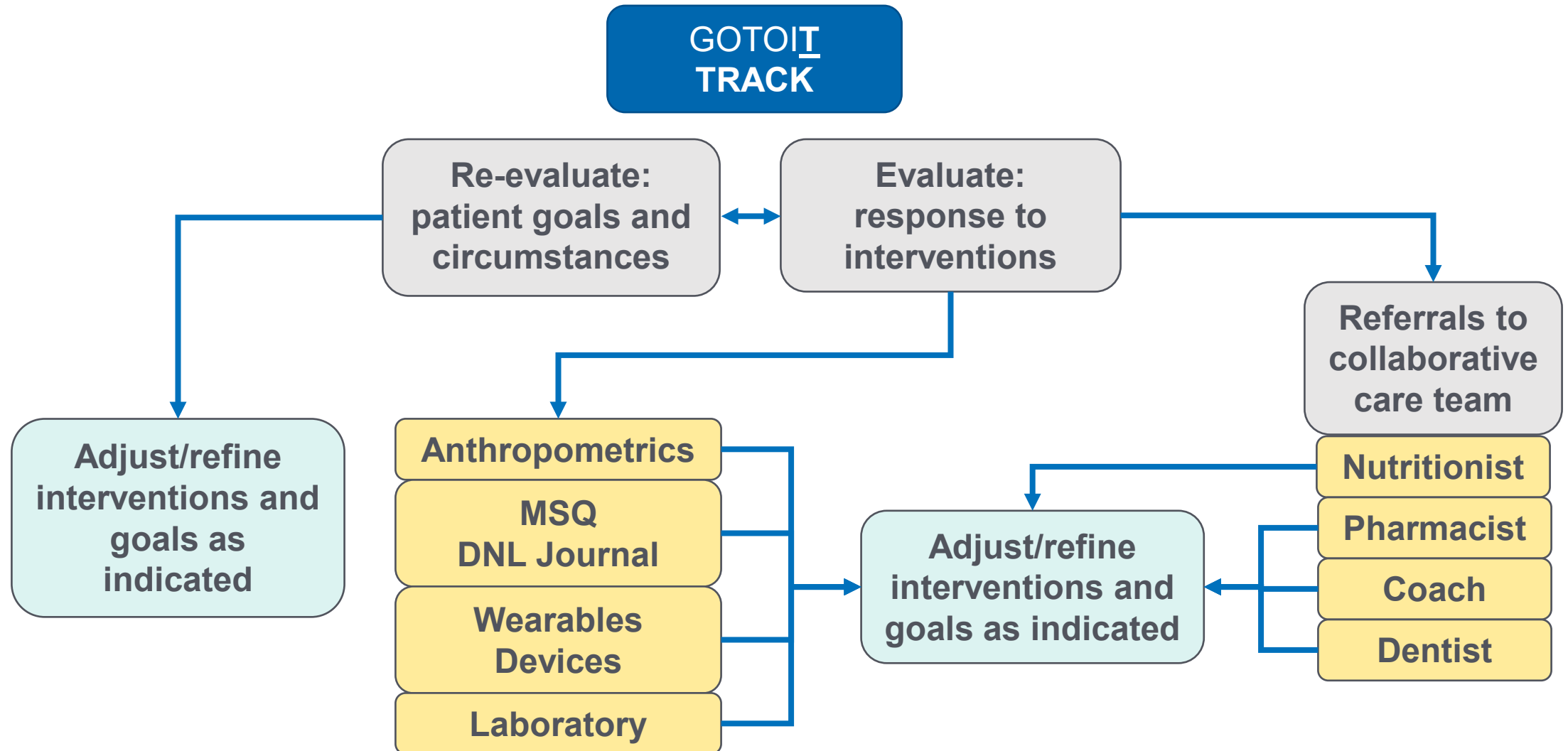
Clinical Focus:

- Summary and conclusion
- Clinical flow path for the Track step



Key Clinical Takeaway:

Flow Path for the Track Step of GOTOIT



Long Description

- Flow path for the Track step of G O T O I T. Evaluate responses to interventions by tracking data from anthropometrics, M S Q, D N L journal, wearable devices, and laboratory results. Re-evaluate patient goals and circumstances by adjusting and refining interventions and goals as indicated. Make referrals to the collaborative care team including nutritionists, pharmacists, coaches, and dentists as needed.